The following are two approaches to explicitly create (or update) a schema. Figure 4.5 demonstrates using both APIs to create a `movies` index:

- *Indexing APIs*—We can create a schema definition at the time of index creation using the `create index` API (not the `mapping` API) for this purpose. The `create index` API expects a request consisting of the required schema definition as a JSON document. The new index and its mapping definitions are created simultaneously.
- *Mapping APIs*—As our data model matures, we will sometimes need to update the schema definition with new attributes. Elasticsearch provides a `_mapping` endpoint to carry out this action, allowing us to add fields and their data types.

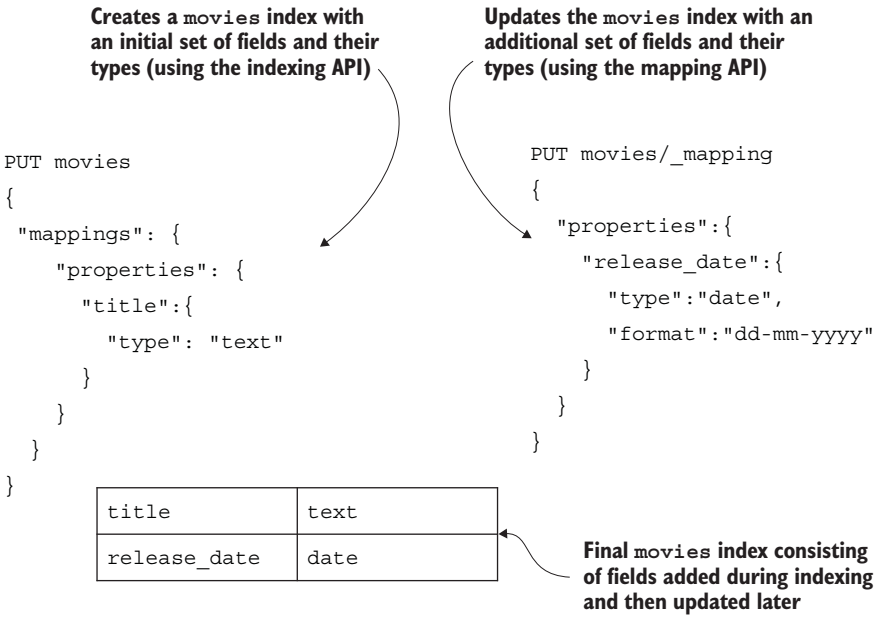


Figure 4.5 Creating and updating a schema using the indexing and mapping APIs

The next section looks at these two methods. We'll follow an example in which we are working with employee data.

4.3.1 Mapping using the indexing API

Creating a mapping definition at the time of index creation is relatively straightforward. We simply issue a `PUT` command followed by the index name and pass the `mappings` object with all the required fields and their details as the body of the request (see figure 4.6).